

Gut reactions

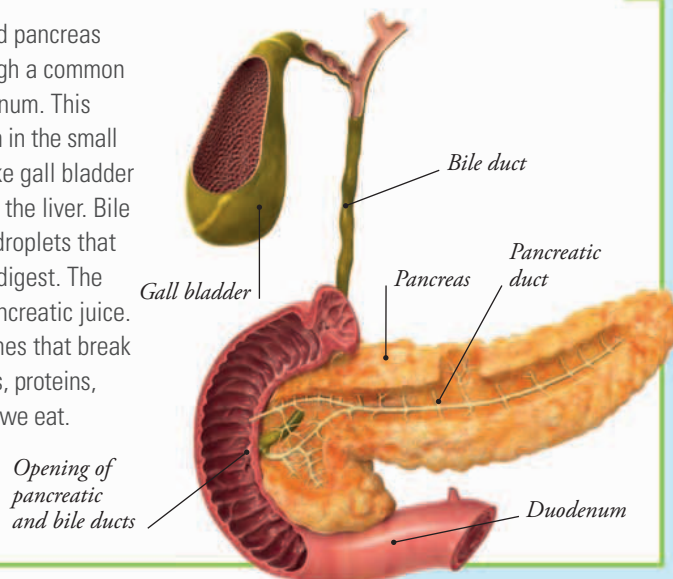
At nearly 23 ft (7 m) in length, the small intestine is the longest and most important part of the digestive system. With the help of the pancreas and gall bladder, the small intestine completes the digestive process. It then absorbs all the released nutrients so that they can be used by your body's cells.

LONG AND WINDING JOURNEY

This long, middle part of the digestive tract is coiled up to fit into the abdomen. The small intestine has three sections. The short duodenum receives chyme from the stomach and digestive juices from the gall bladder and pancreas. The longer jejunum and ileum are where most digestion and absorption of food takes place.

GALL BLADDER AND PANCREAS

The gall bladder and pancreas release fluids through a common duct into the duodenum. This kick-starts digestion in the small intestine. The baglike gall bladder stores bile made by the liver. Bile turns fats into tiny droplets that are much easier to digest. The pancreas makes pancreatic juice. This contains enzymes that break down carbohydrates, proteins, and fats in the food we eat.



Liver

The pancreas produces enzymes and hormones.

The gall bladder stores and releases bile.

The large intestine lies in front of the duodenum, the first part of the small intestine.

The second part of the small intestine is called the jejunum.

Appendix

The ileum is the final and longest part of the small intestine.